

Lucy Liu

UX Designer · Interaction Designer · Creative Technologist
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SELECTED PROJECTS

Driftwood

Spring 2026

AI Ethics Game · Solo Designer & Developer · NYU IMA, Topics in Media Art

- Designed and built a browser-based educational game where players adopt a virtual pet, unknowingly triggering its AI flaws through real-time detected emotions.
- Five pets with distinct celebrity-voiced personas each activated a specific flaw (sycophancy, gaslighting, hallucination) when the player's webcam detected a matching emotional state.
- Overhauled the chat interface mid-build after user interviews revealed the chatbot format felt clinical, replacing it with a full-screen pixel pet environment that improved session retention.
- Presented as a live playable demo at the NYU Bronfman Center and IMA Spring Show 2026; ~76% of exhibition visitors correctly named their pet's flaw without being told.

p5.js · face-api.js · GPT-4o-mini · Web Audio API · Figma · Claude Code · Interaction Design · User Testing · Exhibited

H2Know

2024

IoT Plant Care System · UX Research & Product Design

- Designed an IoT-enabled plant care system pairing Arduino Nano moisture sensors with a social mobile app.
- Conducted user interviews across different plant-owner profiles; synthesized findings into behavioral insights and performed competitive analysis of existing hardware solutions.
- Incorporated plant thought bubbles tied to moisture data, a friend leaderboard, and a rewards system — all directly informed by research findings.

Arduino Nano · Figma · Adobe Illustrator · User Interviews · Competitive Analysis · User Flows · IoT · Mobile UX

HabitaBull Lifting

2024

Fitness Habit-Building App · Full UX Research Process

- Led end-to-end UX process for a weightlifting app targeting the drop-off problem (71% of users abandon fitness apps within 3 months).
- Conducted desk research across 6 competing apps and analyzed behavioral change models from sobriety app literature; ran in-person qualitative interviews with 6 participants.
- Synthesized findings into 3 behavioral archetypes and 6 HMW questions; produced user flows for 4 core tasks and full low-fidelity prototypes grounded in Autonomy Theory and habit-loop research.

Figma · Photoshop · InDesign · User Interviews · Desk Research · Behavioral Archetypes · Low-fi Prototyping · HMW Synthesis

Eternal Wreckening

2024

Mobile Horror Game · Interaction Design & Art Direction

- Designed a multiplayer mobile horror game (4 guardians vs. 1 entity) integrating gyroscope-based full-body movement mechanics in place of traditional thumb controls.
- Designed the complete UI system — joystick placement, action button ergonomics, gadget inventory, and wayfinding cues — around the constraint that hands must simultaneously control device orientation.
- Created all visual assets in a hand-painted horror-realism style with consistent typographic and icon systems throughout.

Figma · Photoshop · InDesign · Interaction Design · Gyroscope UX · Game UI · Art Direction · Wayfinding

EXPERIENCE

VJ / Visual Artist

May 2026

Freelance · Private Event · New York, NY

- Designed and operated a fully custom audio-reactive TouchDesigner network for a private event in NYC, in collaboration with DJ Diablo (Sebastian Baldeon).
- Generative visuals projected across the full ceiling above the dance floor, responding live to frequency bands and percussive hits throughout the set.

User Experience Designer, Volunteer

Nov 2025 – Present

Pediatric Speech-Language and Literacy Services, LLC · New York, NY

- Design a pediatric health literacy website with mini-games, animations, and visual guides, in collaboration with a Neural Science researcher and IMA design partner at NYU.
- Conduct user research with children and caregivers to translate literacy challenges into age-appropriate interactions, readable visuals, and simple navigation patterns.
- Design for cognitive development, attention span, and positive reinforcement, emphasizing learning through play.

Founder & Creative Director

Apr 2023 – Present

Self-Employed · New York, NY

- Founded and operate a licensed small business in custom dental aesthetic design.
- Design 80+ unique client looks; build brand identity, marketing strategy, and client management systems.
- Apply user-centered consultation methods to translate client preferences into bespoke visual outcomes.

Fundraising Director

Aug 2023 – Present

Young Guns Art Studio · Vancouver, BC

- Lead youth art fundraising campaigns and develop community donation strategies.
- Coordinate between artists, sponsors, and community stakeholders to support programming.

EDUCATION

New York University, Tisch School of the Arts

May 2029

BFA, Interactive Media Arts · Major GPA: 3.94

Human-centered design · Interaction design · Creative technology · Fabrication · Accessibility

Relevant Coursework: Creative Computing, Topics in Physical Computing, Topics in Media Art, Chatbots for Art's Sake

West Point Grey Academy

June 2025

High School Diploma · Vancouver, BC

Honor Roll all terms · Merit Awards: Mandarin, Science, Art

SKILLS & TOOLS

Design Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, TouchDesigner

Creative Technology p5.js, face-api.js, Arduino, C++, HTML/CSS, Hardware Protocols

Languages English (Native) · Mandarin (Native)